Opportunity needs a first step.

AFJ's leadership describes education and innovation as a pathway to opportunity. Hack876 gives young Jamaicans one day to take their first step down it.

WHAT HACK876 IS

A one-day build competition in Kingston for about 80 secondary-school students, 5th Form through Upper 6th Form, working in teams of 3 to 4. Teams pick a real problem and finish the day with a working prototype and a pitch to judges.

When: Saturday, February 20, 2027 (tentative)

Where: Spanish Court Hotel, Kingston (confirmed)

Who: About 80 students, roughly 20 teams

Organisers: Nadani Dixon and Stefen Ewers



WHY AFJ

AFJ funds education and economic development in Jamaica through an annual grant cycle, and its leadership describes education and innovation as a pathway to opportunity.

WHAT WE ARE ASKING

Tell us whether Hack876 would be a suitable applicant in AFJ's next grant cycle, for a programme grant within AFJ's usual range.

WHAT IT MAKES POSSIBLE

Programme costs for the day: student meals, materials, equipment and running the event. Not student prizes, because AFJ does not make grants to individuals.

WHAT AFJ RECEIVES

A defined project of about 80 students, with reporting every six months in the way AFJ asks of every grantee.

THE NEXT STEP

A yes or no on whether to apply, and which registered recipient AFJ would need: a partner registered under the Jamaica Charities Act, or a school through its Principal's office.

Nadani Dixon and Stefen Ewers, Hack876 organisers · info@hack876.com

01 WHY AFJ

A grant-maker for education in Jamaica, with clear rules.

Hack876 is one day where tutoring, job readiness and a first working build meet in the same room.

AFJ'S MISSION

"The American Friends of Jamaica is a not-for-profit 501(c)(3) organization dedicated to support Jamaican charitable organizations and social initiatives committed to sustainably transforming the lives of Jamaicans."[2]

AFJ looks for organisations with "measurable impact, an efficient track record and excellence."[3]

Its education grants already reach tutoring for secondary school students and job training programmes.[3]

Economic development grants are weighed on their potential for job readiness and job creation.[3]

SINCE 1982

1982

Founded by a handful of Jamaicans and Americans who loved Jamaica and wanted to see it prosper.[2]

SINCE 1982

About US$20.4 million in grants across education, healthcare and economic development.[3]

2025

A dedicated grant makes a national coding challenge free for students in grades 4 to 12.[4]

2026

US$1.3 million to 65 organisations, presented at the United States Embassy.[5]

02 OUR REQUEST

A programme grant, through AFJ's own process.

A programme grant ACKNOWLEDGEMENT AS AFJ PREFERS

AFJ's grants typically range from US$1,000 to US$20,000. We are asking about a grant toward programme costs, in an amount AFJ considers appropriate. An application would follow AFJ's cycle, through a recipient AFJ can fund.

WHAT IT HELPS SUPPORT

- **Programming.** Helps support mentoring, judging and the student programme.
- **Equipment.** Helps support the equipment teams build with.
- **Materials.** Contributes toward participant materials and supplies.
- **Logistics.** Contributes toward running the day.
- **Student meals.** Contributes toward meals and refreshments on the day.

AFJ does not fund grants to individuals, so a grant would support programme costs and not student prizes.

WHAT AFJ WOULD RECEIVE

Recognition agreed with AFJ, and a written recap after the event.

The judging panel decides every award. Sponsorship does not buy influence over judging, and no level carries naming rights.

A first-year event, with the essentials in place.

ORGANISERS	Nadani Dixon (Redfin) and Stefen Ewers (Georgia Tech) lead the event and are the contacts for this proposal.
VENUE	Spanish Court Hotel in Kingston is confirmed as the venue.
DATE	Saturday, February 20, 2027 is the working date. It is tentative until confirmed with schools.
JUDGES	7 judges have confirmed, from Tesla, Microsoft, Meta, Google, Accenture, Diageo, HashiCorp.
THE DAY	One day, 8:00 AM to 7:30 PM: an opening, a build period with mentors, judging, finals and awards.

SCHOOL NETWORK AND STATUS

Hillel Academy	IN TALKS
Campion College	CONFIRMED
Jamaica College	NOT YET CONFIRMED
Immaculate Conception High School	NOT YET CONFIRMED
Wolmer's	NOT YET CONFIRMED
Ardenne High School	IN TALKS
American International School of Kingston	NOT YET CONFIRMED
St. Andrew High School for Girls	NOT YET CONFIRMED
St. George's College	NOT YET CONFIRMED

1 confirmed, 2 in talks, 6 not yet confirmed. This is the network where the Hack876 team has relationships. It is not a list of confirmed participants, and it is not an exclusive eligibility list.

SAFEGUARDS. MANY PARTICIPANTS ARE MINORS.

Sponsors do not receive student contact details, and there are no sign-ups or selling on the day.

Mentors and volunteers work in open, supervised spaces.

Photos and names are used only with school and parent consent.

The judging panel decides every award. Sponsorship carries no influence over judging and no naming rights.

What you would see afterwards, and what we need from you now.

WHAT YOU WOULD RECEIVE AFTERWARDS: A WRITTEN RECAP

- ✓ **How many students, teams and schools took part**
- ✓ **What the teams built, with the finalist projects described**
- ✓ **How your contribution was used**
- ✓ **Photos, only where schools and parents have consented**

We will document the recognition delivered and report the results we have. Audience reach and commercial outcomes are not guaranteed. Student contact details are not shared.

POSSIBLE LATER, ONLY IF BOTH SIDES FIND IT VALUABLE. NOT COMMITMENTS.

A multi-school grant in a later cycle, once year one has results to report.

Introductions to AFJ's tutoring and job-training grantees, so students have somewhere to go next.

A challenge shaped around a community need AFJ's grantees see every day.

Diaspora supporters giving through AFJ's donor directed route, if they ask.

THE DECISION WE ARE ASKING FOR

A yes or no on whether to apply, and which registered recipient AFJ would need: a partner registered under the Jamaica Charities Act, or a school through its Principal's office.

AFJ does not conduct pre-proposal meetings, so this page is a brief interest check, not a request for one.[6]

Your contact: Nadani Dixon and Stefen Ewers, Hack876 organisers · info@hack876.com

We would love to explore whether Hack876 fits a coming grant cycle with Caron and the AFJ team.

GROUND RULES WE WILL HOLD OURSELVES TO

No marketing to students. AFJ appears as a supporter, never in anything pitched at them.

No student data is collected for or shared with partners. Names and photos only with school and parental consent.

Grant funds go to programme costs only, never to fundraising activities or indirect costs.

05 APPENDIX

Sources.

SOURCES

1. The American Friends of Jamaica, "Our Team." theafj.org/our-team/

2. The American Friends of Jamaica, "About Us." theafj.org/about-us/

3. The American Friends of Jamaica, "Grants." theafj.org/grants/

4. Seprod, "Seprod Foundation and AFJ Deepen Commitment to STEAM Education Through Code Jamaica (August 11, 2025)." www.seprod.com/seprod-foundation-and-afj-deepen-commitment-to-steam-education-through-code-jamaica/

5. Jamaica Observer, "Belmont Academy, Newell High get hurricane recovery boost from AFJ (April 16, 2026)." www.jamaicaobserver.com/2026/04/16/belmont-academy-newell-high-get-hurricane-recovery-boost-afj/

6. The American Friends of Jamaica, "FAQs." theafj.org/f-a-q/

A private partnership proposal prepared for Caron Chung, Executive Director, The American Friends of Jamaica.